were mainly defending their kingdom against other kingdoms, both Muslim *and* Hindu.

The Modern Raya of Anegundi

A day after meeting Krishna Devaraya in Hospet, I take a ferry across the Tungabhadra to visit his ancestral home in Anegundi, a dusty village with a population of 4000. This home, built 200 years ago, stands across a ruined fort-palace—the place from where the Sangama brothers likely launched their imperial dreams nearly 700 years ago.



Figure 11. Krishna Devaraya's family home

Krishna greets me warmly. He is a soft-spoken man of medium height. His blue jeans and white T-shirt, bushy moustache, and red tilak convey a relaxed yet serious persona. His living room is like a tastefully renovated mini palace from another era. He asks a maid for tea as we settle down on diwan-style sofas to begin our conversation.

His personal history seems oddly commonplace. Krishna grew up in the vicinity, studied mechanical engineering from Davangere, married in his